

COVID conscious
lesbian bar in
western MA - Boston
Globe
Serene - Necrosis

10/5/26
9/30/26

GWSS 4-3-2-1

"Identity" by Kaplan: the concept of

Key point: rather than fixed identities that can lead to tribalism, acting as a lifetime of confinement, a fluid and changing paradigm holds these labels can be taken and put back as the subject themselves changes too.

"Experience" by Nimi Thi Nguyen:

Key point: Using experience as a "truth" locks complexity by setting forth an ontology with assumptions on how an identity should be implemented in the social order, without describing how and why those assumptions were made.

"Deviance" by Prof. Adeyemi:

Key point: Deviance is not definitionally an intentional resistance against subjugation; it can just be a means of human expression for personal fulfillment. The former tends to assign some inherent "other-ness" to minorities which enables the same racist, sexist, etc. societal subjugation which reclaiming the term wants to avoid.

"Normal" by Robert McRuer:

Key point: Power is an ever-changing system to act on different groups, even by defining the very concept of such a division. Who is using it on who is a trite reduction of a force that impacts also the privileged parties wielding said power.

"Normal" by Robert McRuer:

Key term: "Normal" = "free from any disorder" (Oxford English Dictionary) ^{the gods of medical class of health and also identity}

check!

→ "Identity" by Carla Kaplan:

Key term: W.E.B. Du Bois' "double consciousness" = the idea that people who belong to marginalized groups have to fight an internal and external battle OF awareness between their various identities, holding them all not as objective truths of themselves but in balance with and against each other as they navigate discrimination and subjugation.

"Experience" by Mimi Thi Nguyen:

Key term: "Standpoint epistemologies" = ^{the concept that} a certain standing in the social order has its own related set of experiences ^{or identity} and understanding that frames the actions of people with that standing, as well as discourse on the standpoint, typically expressed by those external to that standing.

"Quote: 'Women of color [are seen in the classroom] as objects of knowledge—as persons to learn about—against white women as agents of knowledge, as persons to learn from.'"

This quote I have even shared with my friends because it recontextualized my entire history of, well, history education. I often see the classroom as a sacred space of learning, free from mindless division of race or socioeconomic class. "An integral does not care who is solving it," maybe—but a history essay

does, through (for one) a lens of experience. Even just recognizing that well-intentioned conversations about marginalized individuals ^{like in school} can be counter-productive to reducing said societal discrepancies is critical and meaningful work.

"Normal" by Robert Mckuer

Quote: "Over the course of the nineteenth century, statistical measurement became an imperative; not only could human characteristics be observed and plotted on graphs and charts, but they should be."

I found myself in a little internal debate; I'm a physics major so I try to push back, especially these days, against anti-science discourse. To me, a cis het privileged young adult, it's just a (very useful!) graph I use everyday, but my measures of optical intensity are someone else's justification for eugenics or "freak shows" - something I sort of already knew about but was able to forget. Reading even just the one paragraph genuinely floored me. I need to remember how feeling saintly can be damaging; our science can be and is being used for rhetoric I am against but still enabling. I have little control over that, but even acknowledgement can help.

Question: In what specific ways does neoliberal capitalism, a system seemingly that values privilege, normalcy and conformity, embrace and sell back abnormality and freakiness?